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GREENBRIER CONFERENCE/Presentation

It's a pleasure to be here with you today --- among friends.

I say among friends because out there (in the field) there is a war going on. And, as with any major conflict, there are bitter hostilities, raging charges and counter-charges, great victories and tremendous losses.

It's a political war. And the field of battle is taken up by people, just as in military wars. People make the difference between winning and losing. Their capabilities, their motivation and drive to win --- or not, and their sheer numbers; these factors determine the course of battles.

I am proud to represent the Tobacco Institute and a great American industry in the western states. I can tell you that we are fortunate to have exceptionally qualified, capable and efficient lobbyists in our state capitals. The tobacco distributor associations are dedicated and anxious to help ... after all, they are trying to protect and save their businesses from the ravages of this political war too. And company representatives in the field also appear desirous of seeing us win. However, I must be frank with you; thus far, this potentially potent field force of company representatives is little more than a "phantom army" in terms of actualized support. And I need not remind you that throughout history neither military nor political wars have been won with phantom or paper armies.

Put another way: If the same kind of "hutzpah" and "esprit" that goes into winning share of market in the competitive marketplace were to be applied to winning the political and social battle to protect and save the tobacco consuming public market, we would indeed be in an excellent position. ~~Endorse~~

Let me give you a few examples. At a recent meeting of distributors and company representatives designed to mount an effort to combat an ordinance to prohibit smoking in Santa Clara County---with over 1 1/2 million residents, these were a few comments I heard:

- "I'd like to do something, this is important; but we'd have to get clearance from our legal department back East." [Company rep.]
- "We'll do whatever you ask---yes, write letters to the supervisors and telephone them too." [Nothing done!]
- "If the companies' own people aren't concerned enough to do something about it why should we." [A distributor]

EP rec'd from Knepper - T.I.

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